

## 9. Peer Interaction

Objective terms for describing how a child relates to and interacts with other children.

*Describe what you observe — not what you interpret about the child's social skills or intent.*

### Proximity & Awareness of Peers

|                                                      |                                             |                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| played in the same area as peers without interaction | watched peers' play from a distance of ____ | moved closer to peers over time                  |
| moved away when a peer approached                    | stayed at the edge of the group             | sat within ____ feet of peers during circle time |
| chose to play in isolated areas most often           | chose busy group areas most often           |                                                  |

### Initiating Interaction

|                                            |                                                      |                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| approached a peer and offered a toy        | approached a peer and said '____'                    | tapped a peer on the shoulder to get attention  |
| made eye contact and smiled at a peer      | entered a peer's play by adding a block              | invited a peer to play by saying '____'         |
| initiated physical play (running, chasing) | did not initiate interactions during the observation | initiated ____ interactions during ____ minutes |

### Responding to Peer Interaction

|                                         |                                                              |                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| smiled when a peer approached           | accepted the toy offered by a peer                           | declined the toy and turned away                |
| responded to peer's question with words | responded to peer's question with gestures                   | ignored peer initiations during the observation |
| moved away when a peer spoke to them    | played alongside peer for ____ minutes after initial contact | joined peer play and sustained it for ____      |

### Conflict & Repair with Peers

|                                                  |                                                  |                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| pushed a peer when ____ occurred                 | took a toy without asking                        | said 'stop' or 'no' to a peer              |
| waited for a peer to finish before taking a turn | asked 'can I have a turn?' with verbal prompting | attempted to trade materials with a peer   |
| walked away from conflict without escalating     | accepted adult mediation during conflict         | returned to play with the peer within ____ |
| apologized verbally or with a gesture            |                                                  |                                            |